

Final Frontier Backs CulturePulse to Scale Artificial Intelligence That Predicts Conflict Before It Happens

Final Frontier Backs CulturePulse to Scale AI That Simulates Entire Populations, Deployed with UN Agencies and Selected for NATO's DIANA Accelerator

Bratislava, Slovakia – 30 June 2026 – [CulturePulse](#), the AI company whose population-scale simulations have helped UNDP cut gender-based deaths in Bosnia by more than half and have been used to model conflict and cooperation from Northern Ireland to South Sudan, has been backed by [Final Frontier](#), the Danish venture capital fund investing in European space and defence technologies, as part of its seed round.

Created by [Justin E. Lane](#) (DPhil, Oxford), a computational social scientist who spent fifteen years studying why societies hold together and why they fracture, CulturePulse turns the question of human conflict into something leaders can simulate. Where traditional polling takes weeks and large-language-model tools are too expensive and scientifically unproven to predict behaviour, CulturePulse models how people form beliefs, resist narratives, and shift toward or away from violence, before it happens. The company has been trusted by United Nations agencies, selected for NATO's DIANA accelerator, and proven in some of the world's hardest conflict environments, from Northern Ireland to Bosnia and Herzegovina to South Sudan, to the Middle East.

Final Frontier joins CulturePulse's €2.5M seed round, which is led by American venture firm **B Ventures Group**, alongside **Rockaway Ventures** (Czechia), **Simpact Ventures** (Poland), and **Zero Gravity Capital** (Slovakia). The proceeds will accelerate go-to-market execution and product development across CulturePulse's defence and enterprise platforms, positioning the company for a Series A in 2027. Over the next twelve months, CulturePulse is targeting new government contracts and enterprise pilots, and qualification for the next phase of NATO's DIANA programme.

Predicting Conflict Before It Happens

CulturePulse was born out of a single question: what makes a society stable, what makes it unstable, and what drives it to fracture. Lane wrote one of the first academic papers proposing the use of artificial intelligence to model social systems, years before the first large language model, and co-founded the company with social scientist F. LeRon Shults, a longtime

collaborator on the underlying research. Together they have spent the years since proving the approach in the field rather than the lab.

The results speak for themselves. In Bosnia and Herzegovina, CulturePulse worked with UNDP to model trust and instability and to test policy before it was rolled out; following implementation, gender-based deaths fell by an estimated 57 to 80% in 2025, off the back of more than 148,000 simulation experiments. During the COVID-19 pandemic, the Norwegian government brought in CulturePulse to understand the spread of misinformation and sharpen public-health messaging without resorting to censorship or content moderation. In Northern Ireland, the Balkans, and South Sudan, CulturePulse worked with Cambridge University's Woolf Institute to turn tens of millions of news articles into predictive models of conflict and cooperation, including a forecast, since borne out, that South Sudan would slide back into conflict.

"When you can predict behaviour all the way up to a whole nation, it de-risks almost every decision a leader has to make," said **Justin E. Lane, CEO and Co-Founder of CulturePulse**. "Decision-makers often have 18 hours to respond to a crisis, not 18 months. I'm glad I was able to build a technology that can help defence departments win wars without firing a shot."

Built to Model How People Actually Think

At the core of CulturePulse is its proprietary Social Information Model (SIM), an engine built to mirror how people reason and decide, not just how they string words together. That design lets it simulate hundreds of millions of people at once, across more than 200 languages, while keeping every result traceable and explainable, where rival AI tools struggle to model more than a few hundred.

The efficiency gap is structural. Where a prior study of the Austrian economy took a national supercomputer thousands of compute hours, CulturePulse's 10-million-agent digital twin reproduced it at equal or better fidelity in 45 minutes, and can now re-run three years of that economy's activity in just over five minutes. The company says the same efficiency shows up in cost: its work for UNDP, running more than a million simulations, cost in the tens of thousands of euros against an estimated €2 million-plus for an equivalent large-language-model system, a reduction of roughly 97%.

That engine powers **ARES**, CulturePulse's platform for government and defence, which runs narrative detection, psychological segmentation, threat profiling, and scenario simulation. The same technology extends to enterprise, testing how audiences will react to messaging, campaigns, and brands before they go live. Both rest on population-scale digital twins, from a 5.5-million-agent model of Slovakia to one built from 86 million online profiles, with prototype national twins of the United Kingdom, Poland, and the Baltics already extending toward full NATO coverage.

Validated Where It Matters Most

CulturePulse was selected for NATO's DIANA accelerator as the only company in the entire 2026 cohort chosen for Social Terrain Mapping, and the only company from Slovakia, selected

from roughly 3,600 global applicants. Its named engagements span UNDP, the Norwegian Government, and Cambridge University's Woolf Institute, and in 2025 it established a UK subsidiary, CulturePulse Ltd., to service the British market from London.

"Understanding how people think is the hardest problem in modern security, and CulturePulse is a rare company actually making progress on it. We are proud to back Justin and his team," said [Niels Vejrup Carlsen](#), Founding Partner, Final Frontier.

From Project Work to Product

CulturePulse is roughly five years into their deep-tech journey, yet its technology is already deployed in the real world. The company is now moving from bespoke project work to recurring product revenue, selling the same engine into defence, government, and enterprise. The raise comes as investment pours into population simulation, a field drawing fast-growing interest from defence and commercial buyers alike; CulturePulse's edge is that it has been proven outside the lab, in live crises rather than benchmarks.

About CulturePulse

CulturePulse builds psychologically realistic digital twins of entire populations, letting governments, defence ministries, and companies test a decision a thousand times in simulation before making it once for real. Delivered through its ARES platform, the technology has been used by UNDP, the Norwegian Government, and Cambridge University's Woolf Institute, and was selected for NATO's DIANA accelerator. Founded by Justin E. Lane (DPhil, Oxford) and F. LeRon Shults, CulturePulse is incorporated in Delaware as CulturePulse, Inc., with its R&D hub in Bratislava, Slovakia, and a subsidiary in London.

About Final Frontier

Final Frontier is a Danish venture capital fund investing in European startups specialising in space and defence technologies. Founded in 2024 with €4.5 million in capital under management, the fund focuses on pre-seed and seed-stage investments across the national security and European resilience value chain. Notable investors include former NATO Secretary General Anders Fogh Rasmussen, who has emphasised that "developing a strong and resilient defence industry requires private capital."

Contact

CulturePulse
Jakub Sustar @ VP Strategy & Expansion
jsustar@culturepulse.ai
www.culturepulse.ai

Final Frontier
Martin Majercin @ Founding Member, Platform
media@finalfrontier.vc
www.finalfrontier.vc

